

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

Nielsen Norman Group — Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics

Evaluator:	Cienna Angela V. Peley	
Date:	May 07, 2026	
Product:	CourtSched System	
Task:	Court Reservation, View Request	

Heuristic 1: Visibility of System Status

Issues	Recommendations
None	No action is needed.

Heuristic 2: Match Between System and the Real World

Issues	Recommendations
✖ No feature for changing language preferences.	✓ Add features for multiple language options that can cater to diverse types of community members with different levels of digital understanding.
✖ No instructions for first time users.	✓ Add pop up instructions for first time users.

Heuristic 3: User Control and Freedom

Issues	Recommendations
✖ Unresponsive cancel button in court reservation.	✓ Make sure the cancel button works upon clicking.
✖ Too small and unresponsive exit button after submission.	✓ Make the exit button work.
✖ No cancel button for pending, approved and rescheduled requests.	✓ Add a cancel request button for all kinds of requests.

Heuristic 4: Consistency and Standards

Issues	Recommendations
✖ The request pages' button is not placed with the other buttons at the top and is also in a different format and color.	✓ Recreate the request page button, place it with the other buttons, and the color the same as the others.

Heuristic 5: Error Prevention

Issues	Recommendations
✖ There should be no “Equipment Needed” space. Realistically speaking, municipalities don’t provide for the needs of participants. It may cause delays and confusion for future events.	✓ Remove the “Equipment Needed” space.

Heuristic 6: Recognition Rather Than Recall

Issues	Recommendations
✖ No feature/option for users who need assistance.	✓ Add features where users can decide what kind of help they want (e.g. page walk-through, step-by-step process).

Heuristic 7: Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Issues	Recommendations
None	No action is needed.

Heuristic 8: Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Issues	Recommendations
None	No action is needed.

Heuristic 9: Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Issues	Recommendations
None	No action is needed.

Heuristic 10: Help and Documentation

Issues	Recommendations
None	No action is needed.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

Nielsen Norman Group — Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics

Evaluator:	Zaira Remalla
Date:	May 07, 2026
Product:	CourtSched System
Task:	View Schedule

Heuristic 1: Visibility of System Status

Issues	Recommendations
■ No loading indicator when fetching schedule data. ■ No 'Last Updated' timestamp on the schedule view.	✓ Add a loading spinner while schedule data is loading. ✓ Display a 'Last Updated' timestamp at the top of the screen.

Heuristic 2: Match Between System and the Real World

Issues	Recommendations
■ Schedule uses system codes unfamiliar to regular users. ■ Entries sorted by case ID instead of date and time.	✓ Replace codes with plain-language labels. ✓ Sort schedule chronologically by date and time.

Heuristic 3: User Control and Freedom

Issues	Recommendations
■ No back/forward navigation without reloading the full page. ■ Switching views loses the user's current date context.	✓ Add back/forward navigation controls without full reload. ✓ Add a 'Today' button for quick return to current date. ✓ Preserve date context when switching between views.

Heuristic 4: Consistency and Standards

Issues	Recommendations
■ Status colors and icons are inconsistent across screens. ■ Date format varies across different screens.	✓ Standardize status color coding across all screens. ✓ Use one consistent date and time format throughout the app.

Heuristic 5: Error Prevention

Issues	Recommendations
■ Invalid dates in the date picker are not validated. ■ Conflicting filters produce an empty schedule with no explanation.	✓ Validate date inputs and disable out-of-range dates. ✓ Show a message when a filter combination yields no results.

Heuristic 6: Recognition Rather Than Recall

Issues	Recommendations
■ Active filters are not shown; users must remember what they set. ■ No saved or recently viewed schedule options.	✓ Show active filters as visible tags on the schedule view. ✓ Add a 'Recently Viewed' or 'Saved Schedules' section.

Heuristic 7: Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Issues	Recommendations
None	No action is needed.

Heuristic 8: Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Issues	Recommendations
None	No action is needed.

Heuristic 9: Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Issues	Recommendations
■ Error messages are vague and don't explain what went wrong. ■ Empty screen does not distinguish between no hearings and a system error.	✓ Write plain-language error messages with clear next steps. ✓ Differentiate empty states from actual errors using distinct messages. ✓ Add a 'Retry' button on all error states.

Heuristic 10: Help and Documentation

Issues	Recommendations
■ No onboarding or guidance for first-time users. ■ No legend or tooltip for color codes and status labels.	✓ Add a short onboarding walkthrough for new users. ✓ Include a legend or tooltip for all color codes and status labels. ✓ Add a Help or FAQ button within the schedule screen.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

Nielsen Norman Group — Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics

Evaluator:	Aeron Jay A. Tapia (Documentation)
Date:	May 8, 2026
Product:	CourtSched System
Task:	View Notification

Heuristic 1: Visibility of System Status

Issues	Recommendations
• The notification bell icon does not display a badge counter. Users have no way to know how many unread notifications they have without opening the Notifications screen.	➤ Add a numeric badge counter on the notification bell icon that updates in real time. Display a 'No new notifications' message when the inbox is empty to confirm the system is functioning.

Heuristic 2: Match Between System and the Real World

Issues	Recommendations
• Notification messages use system-generated language (e.g., 'Reservation status updated: State = 2') that does not match how users think about their bookings.	➤ Rewrite all notification messages in plain, conversational language. Example: 'Your court reservation on May 10 at 3:00 PM has been approved.' Notifications should read like natural announcements, not system logs.

Heuristic 3: User Control and Freedom

Issues	Recommendations
• There is no option to delete or dismiss individual notifications. Users cannot clear their notification inbox, and there is no 'Mark all as read' feature.	➤ Add swipe-to-dismiss functionality on individual notifications. Include a 'Mark all as read' and 'Clear all' button at the top of the Notifications screen to give users full control over their inbox.

Heuristic 4: Consistency and Standards

Issues	Recommendations
• Notification timestamps are formatted inconsistently — some show relative time ('2 hrs ago') while others show absolute time ('10:30 AM, May 7'), causing confusion.	➤ Standardize timestamp format across all notifications. Use relative time for recent notifications (within 24 hours) and switch to absolute date-time for older ones. Apply this format consistently throughout the app.

Heuristic 5: Error Prevention

Issues	Recommendations
None	No action needed

Heuristic 6: Recognition Rather Than Recall

Issues	Recommendations
• The Notifications screen does not visually differentiate between read and unread notifications. All entries look identical, requiring users to remember which ones they have already seen.	➤ Use a visual treatment to distinguish unread from read notifications — e.g., bold text and a colored left border for unread items. Fade or reduce opacity for read notifications. This allows users to recognize status at a glance.

Heuristic 7: Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Issues	Recommendations
• All users see the same notification list with no filtering options. Power users who generate many reservations cannot filter by type (e.g., Approved, Rejected, Pending) to find relevant updates quickly.	➤ Add filter tabs or a dropdown to the Notifications screen: 'All', 'Approved', 'Pending', 'Rejected'. Allow users to sort by newest or oldest. These features help frequent users manage high notification volumes efficiently.

Heuristic 8: Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Issues	Recommendations
None	No action needed

Heuristic 9: Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Issues	Recommendations
• When the Notifications screen fails to load (e.g., due to a connection issue), it displays a blank screen with no error message, leaving users uncertain whether they have notifications or the screen is broken.	➤ Display a clear, friendly error message when notifications fail to load: 'Could not load notifications. Check your connection and try again.' Include a retry button. Use a distinct empty-state illustration when there are genuinely no notifications.

Heuristic 10: Help and Documentation

Issues	Recommendations
• First-time users do not know what types of notifications to expect or how to manage notification preferences. There is no explanation or guidance within the Notifications screen.	➤ Add a brief onboarding tooltip on the Notifications screen explaining what notifications users will receive (e.g., reservation approvals, rejections, reminders). Provide a link to notification preference settings directly from the screen.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

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Evaluator:	Pauline Joy R. Piloneo (Group Leader)
Date:	May 8, 2026
Product:	CourtSched System
Task:	Adjust Accessibility Setting

Heuristic 1: Visibility of System Status

Issues	Recommendations
• The system provides no visual feedback after enabling an accessibility option (e.g., font size increase or high contrast mode). Users cannot tell if the change was applied.	➤ Display an immediate on-screen preview when an accessibility setting is toggled. Add a brief confirmation message (e.g., 'High Contrast Mode enabled') after each change.

Heuristic 2: Match Between System and the Real World

Issues	Recommendations
• The Accessibility Settings panel uses technical labels such as 'Display Rendering Mode' instead of plain terms users expect like 'High Contrast'.	➤ Replace technical labels with plain, everyday language. Use familiar terms: 'Text Size', 'High Contrast', 'Screen Reader Support'. Align labels with OS-level accessibility terminology users already know.

Heuristic 3: User Control and Freedom

Issues	Recommendations
• There is no 'Reset to Default' option inside the Accessibility Settings. Users who accidentally change settings cannot easily undo their changes.	➤ Add a 'Reset to Default' button at the bottom of the Accessibility Settings screen. Allow users to undo the last change immediately after it is applied.

Heuristic 4: Consistency and Standards

Issues	Recommendations
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- The toggle switches in Accessibility Settings use a different visual style (square toggles) compared to toggles used elsewhere in the app (rounded toggles).

- Standardize all toggle components across the app to use the same rounded design. Maintain consistent color treatment for active and inactive states throughout all settings screens.

Heuristic 5: Error Prevention

Issues	Recommendations
None	No action needed

Heuristic 6: Recognition Rather Than Recall

Issues	Recommendations
• The Accessibility Settings panel is located in a sub-menu under 'Profile > More Options', making it difficult to discover. Users must remember its location each visit.	➤ Move Accessibility Settings to a prominent, top-level location. Add a persistent accessibility shortcut icon in the main navigation bar so users can recognize and reach it in one tap.

Heuristic 7: Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Issues	Recommendations
• There is no quick-access shortcut for enabling frequently used accessibility options such as large text or high contrast mode. All users must navigate through the same multi-step menu.	➤ Add an accessibility floating action button (FAB) accessible from any screen. Allow users to pin their most-used accessibility options to a quick-access panel for faster toggling.

Heuristic 8: Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Issues	Recommendations
• The Accessibility Settings screen displays all available settings simultaneously, including rarely used options, creating visual clutter that overwhelms users with low vision.	➤ Organize accessibility options into logical groups: Visual, Audio, and Interaction. Use collapsible sections to hide infrequently changed options. Keep the default view minimal and focused on the most-used settings.

Heuristic 9: Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Issues	Recommendations
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None	No action needed
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Heuristic 10: Help and Documentation

Issues	Recommendations
• There is no explanation of what each accessibility option does. Users must guess the effect of settings like 'Reduce Motion' or 'Color Filter' without any description or preview.	➤ Add a brief description beneath each accessibility setting explaining its effect (e.g., 'Increases text size across the entire app'). Include a live preview area so users can see changes before confirming.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

Nielsen Norman Group — Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics

Evaluator:	Christopher P. Lagatic
Date:	May 07, 2026
Product:	CourtSched System
Task:	Edit Profile

Heuristic 1: Visibility of System Status

Issues	Recommendations
None	No action needed

Heuristic 2: Match Between System and the Real World

Issues	Recommendations
- No language options - No help for first-time users.	➤ Add language choices and a welcome guide

Heuristic 3: User Control and Freedom

Issues	Recommendations
- Cancel button doesn't work - Exit button is too small	➤ Fix Cancel button ➤ Make Exit button bigger and easier to tap

Heuristic 4: Consistency and Standards

Issues	Recommendations
Save Changes button uses a different color and style	➤ Match it to the same color and style as other buttons

Heuristic 5: Error Prevention

Issues	Recommendations
None	No action needed

Heuristic 6: Recognition Rather Than Recall

Issues	Recommendations
No action needed	. No action needed

Heuristic 7: Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Issues	Recommendations
None	No action needed

Heuristic 8: Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Issues	Recommendations
.None	No action needed

Heuristic 9: Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

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Issues	Recommendations
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